Terrestrial News at Five

by Matt Mills



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(Two news reporters, Stacy and Randy, stand holding microphones in front of a large park.)

STACY. Welcome back to Channel 12, KOPP…PPPP, Your News at Five. I'm Stacy Stacyson…

RANDY. Along with, as always, Randy Randerson. Boat collector extraordinaire *(winks)*.

STACY. We're coming to you live tonight for a very special broadcast. As you can see we are not in our normal studio...

RANDY. I mean, there aren't any walls around here! Can't be the studio. Look! Where are the walls?

STACY. Earlier this afternoon, two bearded hunters on their way back from an unsuccessful hunting trip to the Poconos spotted an alien ship landing here at our very own Walterson Park.

RANDY. I mean, right?! Isn't that insane! Crazy.

STACY. While many of you may not subscribe to the idea that aliens exist—

RANDY. I subscribe! To a lot of things. *Cat Fancy*, *Bird Fancy*…

STACY. We'd like to share with you their stories of what exactly happened.

RANDY. Oh, gosh, I'm too excited. Stories!

STACY. We have with us now the two gentlemen in question. Failed hunters, tell us…what exactly did you see here in Walterson Park?

HUNTER 1. Well, there was like, you know. This big…thing.

HUNTER 2. Yep, yep. I seen it.

HUNTER 1. And then it went, like, down a little bit.

HUNTER 2. Little to the side, too.

HUNTER 1. Yeah, to the side. And uh…there was this light.

HUNTER 2. Big light.

HUNTER 1. Ginormous.

HUNTER 2. Downright prodigious.

HUNTER 1. So then it sort of, like, landed. Like the way a hamburger lands on them plastic trays at a fast food station.

HUNTER 2. You're makin' my tummy growl, Reggie-Ray.

STACY. This "thing" you two spotted…was it like anything you'd ever seen before?

HUNTER 1. No, ma'am, it was unlike anything I'd ever seen before.

HUNTER 2. Yes'sir.

RANDY. Were you scared? *(to the camera)* I'd be scared.

HUNTER 2. Yes'sir.

HUNTER 1. No ma'am.

HUNTER 2. What?

HUNTER 1. I was fine.

HUNTER 2. Alright then.

STACY. So this "thing" landed, there was a bright light and…what happened next?

HUNTER 1. So all of a sudden this thing just opens up and…BOOM! Out comes…our little friend here...

(He slides forward a big scary alien!)

ALIEN. (drools and growls)

STACY. Uh...

RANDY. Oh my gosh, can we keep it?!

STACY. Is that what I think it is?

HUNTER 1. Depends on what you think it is.

HUNTER 2. If you think it's an alien, you're right. If you think it's something else, I'm pretty sure you're wrong, but not positive.

ALIEN. (growls)

STACY. Fellows…are you telling us and our viewers at home that you have actually captured an extra-terrestrial?

HUNTER 1. Heck yes, ma'am! May not have been able to catch any pheasant this morning, but we sure got us a marlin and then some on this one!

HUNTER 2. Then some.

STACY. Wow, planet Earth, you just heard it first here on Channel 12—an alien creature has landed in Walterson Park and is here with us right now.

RANDY. My horoscope was so right; this is a big day for me!

HUNTER 1. So…what do we do now?

HUNTER 2. He don't look so friendly…

ALIEN. (growls)

STACY. As one of the first members of the human race to communicate with an extra-terrestrial life force, I will do my best to give it the benefit of the doubt and hope that it comes in peace. I will do so by conducting an interview, the same way I would conduct an interview with any other person of interest.

RANDY. Ooh, yeah! Ask him what his favorite Leo DiCap' movie is!

STACY. No. Now, Mr. Alien…

RANDY. Is that your name? What if we call him, like…Bob? Ooh, or Juancardo?!

HUNTER 1. I've been callin' her Sheila.

HUNTER 2. Chrysanthemum.

STACY. We'll figure out its name shortly enough, guys. Let's just focus. Now… Mr. or Ms. or Mrs. Alien…uh…shoot, I'm drawing a blank. What should I ask it?

RANDY. Do you have jello in space?

ALIEN. (*pause, growls menacingly*)

RANDY. Okay, no jello. Got it.

HUNTER 1. Do you like sports?

ALIEN. (*pause, smiles*)

HUNTER 2. Oh! That's nice.

STACY. Where do you come from?

(The alien glares silently back at her. Then it burps obnoxiously at them.)

STACY. Well, that's rude.

RANDY. Alright, next question… Do you want to go to the dance with me? Check yes, no, maybe—

STACY. Randy!

RANDY. What? You're not mad that I didn't ask you, are—

STACY. There are more important matters for us to discuss at the moment!

RANDY. Um…like?!

STACY. Why this alien is here, why it traveled millions of miles just to end up her at Walterson Park talking to a news crew from the third-rated news source on its own channel?

RANDY. Hey, we'll get to second some day!

STACY. We've got to figure out its motive. Its agenda. What it wants. *(to the alien)* What do you want?

ALIEN. *(pause)* Destroy humans.

RANDY. Okay, cool! We got it figured out. Now, on a scale of 1-10…*(re: his appearance)* Go.

STACY. Randy, he just said he wants to destroy the human race!

RANDY. Oh. Huh. Well, maybe there's something wrong with the translation.

STACY. Yeah?

RANDY. I mean, I'm amazed it knows any English. I mean, we live like twenty miles from Mexico and I don't know a lick of Spanish past *tortilla*. This thing's from at least…like…nine-hundred…miles away, so…yeah. Ask him again.

STACY. *(clearly)* Alien…do you come in peace?

ALIEN. No.

STACY. And you want to…

ALIEN. Destroy humans.

RANDY. Uh…and you will stop at…

ALIEN. Nothing.

STACY. Until we're…

ALIEN. Destroyed!

STACY. Huh.

RANDY. You know… I think that might be a problem.

STACY. Yeah, that doesn't sound any better.

HUNTER 1. Nope.

HUNTER 2. This is bad.

HUNTER 1. Real bad.

HUNTER 2. Running out of deer-urine in the middle of a hunt kind of bad.

STACY. Well, America, uh…I'm sorry, I feel like I should be doing something here to help us out as a species, but...I'm somewhat in shock right now.

RANDY. Should we like…trap it in a cardboard box? With like a little trap and a carrot to draw it in--

STACY. I think it'll figure that out.

ALIEN. Prepare for extinction, earthlings!

(The alien raises its arms and flicks its tongue at them in an intimidating show.)

STACY. Oh, my!

RANDY. Son of a biscuit that's terrifying. Oof!

STACY. For anyone who's watching, please call the police, or…the president, or a tow-truck, or something!

RANDY. Call my mom and say hi and that I love her and that my cat needs to be fed on Tuesdays and Thursdays! Tuesdays and Thursdays, Mom, you always forget! Gah!

ALIEN. Agh, earthlings!

STACY. Randy, look!

RANDY. Oh…oh my…my…Channel 12 viewers, it appears as though the whole county is descending upon the scene, this is madness! Darn tootin' madness!

ALIEN. Humans, bad! Must…destroy!

RANDY. Aw…you know, he's actually kind of cute when he talks like that.

STACY. No he's not, Randy. He wants to kill us all! Channel 12, it appears we are all in grave danger here. Please, do not come down to Walterson--oh, oh my, my…here come the soldiers!

(Two soldiers come marching down, looking around through the scopes on their rifles.)

SOLDIER 1. Do you see the target?

SOLDIER 2. It's right there.

SOLDIER 1. There?

SOLDIER 2. No, there.

SOLDIER 1. Ohhh, there.

SOLDIER 2. There.

SOLDIER 1. Thanks.

SOLDIER 2. You've got it!

RANDY. Save us please, majestic soldiers!

STACY. Channel 12, things are getting out of hand down here at the park. The army has arrived, and--

RANDY. Oh my god, hi Tom! Tom Tom, over here!

STACY. That is General Tom Tomerson we are seeing as he leads the troops towards saving the world from this vile and, honestly, somewhat smelly extra-terrestrial demon.

(The general marches around the scene, barking orders at his assistant, who follows behind.)

GENERAL. Give me seven snipers over there...

ASSISTANT. Snipers, go sniping!

GENERALS. Infantry come up through these trees…

ASSISTANT. Infantry, don't act like infants in those trees!

GENERAL. And leave radio ops with me.

ASSISTANT. Radio ops, uh…opt to use your radio, should you need to?

GENERAL. Good work, Henry. I'm moving in to confront this little monster.

ASSISTANT. You go, general!

RANDY. Yes, he's the best! TOM! GIVE ME YOUR AUTOGRAPH LATER--he's a little busy, it's okay.

STACY. Planet Earth, it appears as though United States General Tom Tomerson has arrived on the scene to enter into talks with the alien beast. Thank you, General!

RANDY. God I love that guy.

STACY. Who doesn't?!

ALIEN. (*growls*)

STACY. Oh, yeah.

RANDY. That makes sense.

GENERAL. Alright, Alien, we're gonna talk this whole thing through. But first...Henry, come here!

ASSISTANT. *(runs up)* What is it, General?

GENERAL. I'm going to use you as a human shield.

ASSISTANT. Oh. Really?

GENERAL. Yes.

ASSISTANT. Okay, General.

GENERAL. Get on over here…

(His assistant trudges in front of him; the general shifts into place.)

GENERAL. Good. Now, Mr. Trespasser--I mean, Mr. Alien…

ALIEN. (growls violently)

GENERAL. What do you expect to get from our planet?

ALIEN. Destroyed humans!

GENERAL. Hm…and what can we do to change your mind?

ALIEN. Nothing! I change your mind!

GENERAL. Oh, really?

STACY. Alright now America, it appears as though the extra-terrestrial is going to debate our fearless general.

RANDY. Ooh, an honest competition of intellect and wit?! Who's gonna win?!

STACY. Gotta love debate, America.

GENERAL. What chance do you think you have against us, huh? You're one measly little gremlin against the best army in the world. We'd blow you to pieces before you could even try anything.

ALIEN. I promise you, general. We're very convincing in our ways.

GENERAL. Yeah, right. Like you could ever—

(With a pulse shot from the alien, the general gets zapped--he stares back in a daze.)

GENERAL. You're right, alien overlord. You are very convincing in your ways.

STACY. Oh, my. It appears…it appears as though our planet's visitor has begun using its powers to brainwash the United States Army!

RANDY. Looks like we've got ourselves in a pickle, gang!

SOLDIER 1. I want to kill and then repopulate.

SOLDIER 2. Blorg blorg blorg blorg blorg.

RANDY. It's like they're speaking Spanish!

ALIEN. (*growls, waves*)

STACY. Uh, oh. What's that? It looks like the alien wants our attention.

RANDY. Finally. About time you're ready to answer my questions! So. Leo DiCap, go!

STACY. Randy!

RANDY. Sorry.

ALIEN. News-humans of Earth…

STACY. Yes?

RANDY. That's us!

ALIEN. Talk to me.

RANDY. Okay! About what? We could talk about movies, or coffee roasts, or Italian prime ministers…

ALIEN. Talk to me about me!

STACY. Huh?

RANDY. Now…that's kind of a silly request, Mr. Terrestrial…only celebrities and Bridezillas can demand to talk about themse—

(The alien fires a pulse shot at them! Stacy and Randy get zapped then stare at the alien, dazed.)

STACY. We're very glad you're here, Bolzor.

RANDY. Yes. You are a beautiful creature and a wise and all-consuming leader.

STACY. Yes.

RANDY. Yes.

HUNTER 1. Oh, no.

HUNTER 2. Oh, yes, Reggie-Ray. I think we're goners!

ALIEN. (*growls*)

HUNTERS. AH! Run away!

(The hunters run as the alien continues zapping everyone in sight.)

(Transition to the news studio in the future. Stacy and Randy sit as anchors.)

STACY. Well, I hope none of you missed our harrowing experience down at Walterson Park. It certainly was a monumental night that forever changed the course of human history.

RANDY. Yeah, that sure was something else. Some. Thing. Else.

STACY. I know I, personally, am forever changed by what happened.

RANDY. Me, too. Me, too.

STACY. Well, my fellow Blorgmericans, this is Bloxblor, reporting for Channel Blorg: 'More Blorg At Four'.

RANDY. And I'm Blorgy. Tune in next week as we uncover the truth about the human race that once existed and talk about the greatest films that one man, Leonardo DiCaprio, ever created.

STACY. That's all we have for tonight, but remember…

RANDY. Conquer the galaxy and all hail Lord Boxlblorg.

STACY. Goodblorg, fellow Blorgs.

RANDY. And remember…you stay blorgy, Blorgmerica!